

Reduced plasma fibrinogen, serum peroxides, lipids, and apolipoproteins after a 3-week vegetarian diet.



The influence of a 3-week vegetarian diet and fasting on serum concentration of peroxides, lipids, apolipoproteins, and plasma fibrinogen was studied in ten middle-aged fibromyalgia/fibrositis patients (eight women, two men). Mean serum peroxide concentration (estimated as thiobarbituric acid reacting substances) was reduced from 3.60 ± 0.14 to 2.82 ± 0.15 $\mu\text{mol/l}$ ($p = 0.01$) and plasma fibrinogen from 3.33 ± 0.25 to 2.74 ± 0.15 g/l ($p = 0.02$). Serum total cholesterol fell from 6.61 ± 0.50 to 4.83 ± 0.35 mmol/l ($p < 0.0001$), apolipoprotein B from 1.77 ± 0.14 to 1.31 ± 0.11 g/l ($p < 0.0001$), and apolipoprotein A from 1.41 ± 0.09 to 1.23 ± 0.05 g/l ($p = 0.03$). High density lipoprotein cholesterol concentration also decreased somewhat (from 1.26 ± 0.09 to 1.07 ± 0.04 mmol/l , $p = 0.03$). An atherogenic index, reflecting the balance between low and high density lipoproteins, was reduced by 31% (from 5.74 ± 0.79 to 3.97 ± 0.60 , $p = 0.02$). The results suggest that vegetarian diet/fasting may have a beneficial influence on the concentration of serum peroxides and plasma fibrinogen concentration, and on the serum level of several lipoprotein-related coronary risk factors.